



From Payloads to People: The Other Half of the Job

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Why this talk

- Pentesting isn't just about breaking things
- Real impact happens *after* the exploit
- Communication = your most underrated tool.

The illustration depicts a hacker in a dark hoodie with glowing yellow eyes, sitting at a laptop. The laptop screen displays a terminal window with a list of network-related commands and their outputs. The background is dark with faint, glowing circuit-like patterns.

```

*] Serv
*] SMBD
*] Auth
*] SMBD
-] Auth
*] Serv
*] Star
*] Targ
*] Dump
dminist
uest:50
efaultA
DAGUtil
*] Done
*] Stop
  
```

- ```
[HTTP] Sending NTLM authentication request to 10.10.10.69
[HTTP] Host : kali
[WebDAV] NTLMv2 Client : 10.10.10.69
[WebDAV] NTLMv2 Username : BRAVOTEAM\SRV01$
[WebDAV] NTLMv2 Hash : SRV01$::BRAVOTEAM:6bf88e994dcaae4:4A4E96A8A2F3DAF49130964A23E184
5A0039005400370037003400420044000400140057004900330043002E004C004F00430041004C00030034005700
043002E004C004F00430041004C0008003000300000000000000000000000000000004000002F81F87F38E689D02C27B48
00690000000000000000000000
[*] [MDNS] Poisoned answer sent to 10.10.10.69 for name kali.local
[*] [LLMNR] Poisoned answer sent to 10.10.10.69 for name kali
[HTTP] Sending NTLM authentication request to 10.10.10.69
[HTTP] Host : kali
[WebDAV] NTLMv2 Client : 10.10.10.69
```

```
*] Servers started, waiting for connections
*] SMBD-Thread-4: Connection from BRAVOTEAM/SPENSER@10.10.10.69 controlled
*] Authenticating against smb://10.10.10.55 as BRAVOTEAM/SPENSER SUCCEEDED
*] SMBD-Thread-4: Connection from BRAVOTEAM/SPENSER@10.10.10.69 controlled
-] Authenticating against smb://10.10.10.69 as BRAVOTEAM/SPENSER FAILED
*] Service RemoteRegistry is in stopped state
*] Starting service RemoteRegistry
*] Target system bootKey: 0x1acf7339e7d4eca55681fa9795657e99
*] Dumping local SAM hashes (uid:rid:lmhash:nthash)
Administrator:500:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:59fc0f884922b4ce37605113
Guest:501:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0
DefaultAccount:503:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d
DAGUtilityAccount:504:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:cd06b02e9a5d525fd9e
*] Done dumping SAM hashes for host: 10.10.10.55
*] Stopping service RemoteRegistry
```





## The People Side

- Reports, debriefs, and relationships.
- Clients care about risk, not CVEs.
- You are the bridge between tech & action.

### REPORTS ARE OUR MAIN DELIVERABLE



#### EXECUTIVE SUMMARY



for decision makers

#### CLEAR TECHNICAL DETAIL

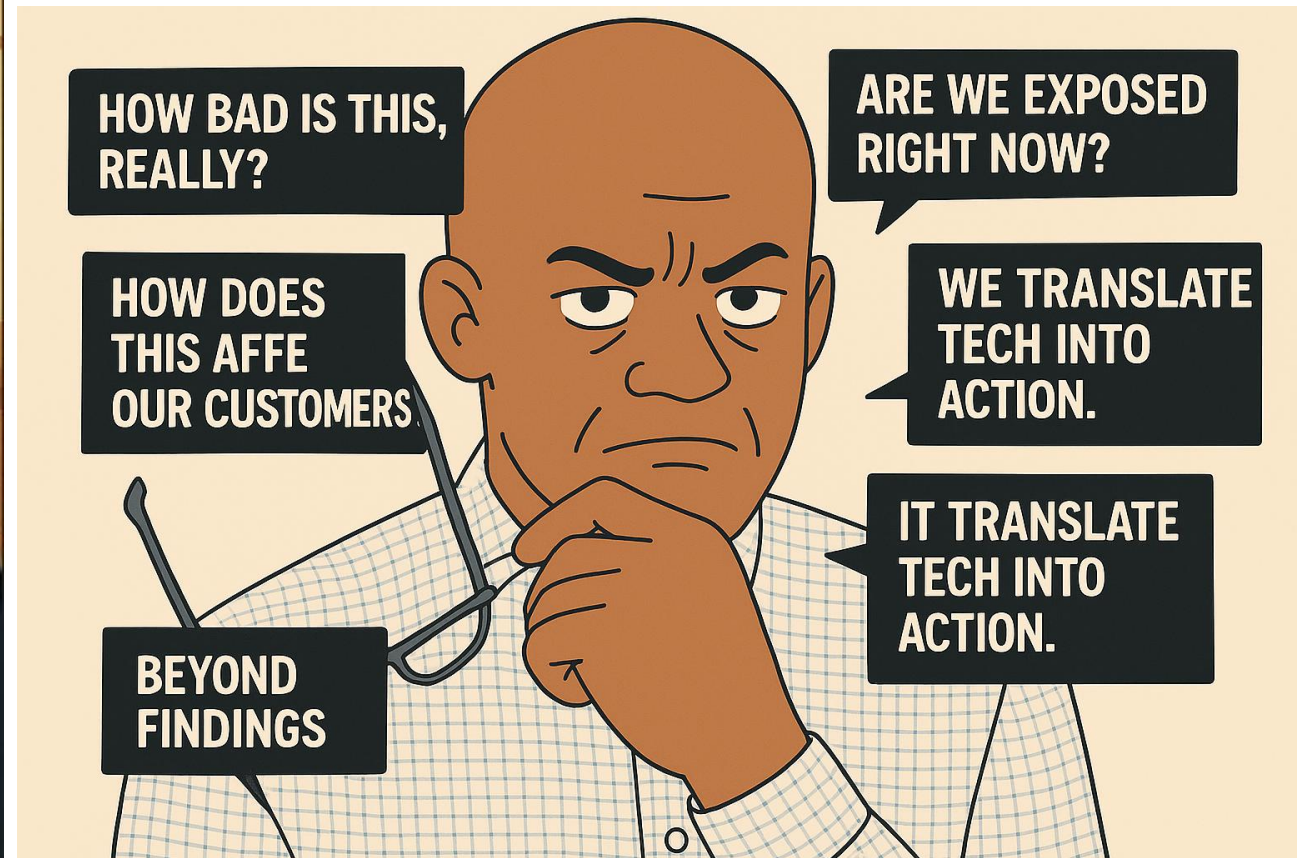


for IT teams

#### PRIORITISATION



so the client knows  
where to start







## Tools of the trade





## Running Effective Debriefs

- Don't just read the report — tell the story.
- Handle tricky questions with clarity.
- Explain risk without jargon.

### STORYTELLING, NOT JUST READING



### HANDLING TRICKY QUESTIONS



### EXPLAINING RISK WITHOUT JARGON





# Soft Skills That Set You Apart

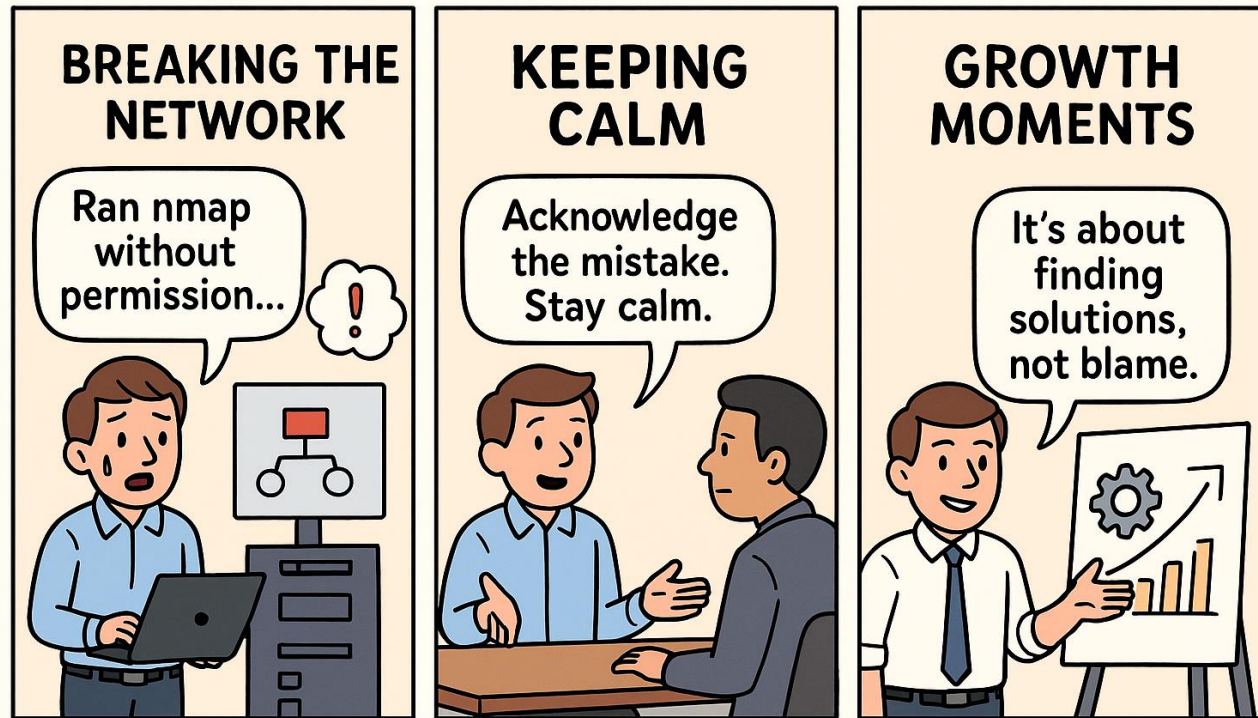




## What I've Learned (the Hard Way)

- Stories from real engagements.
- What worked — and what didn't.
- Growth moments as a consultant.

## WHAT I'VE LEARNED (the HARD WAY





# Practical Takeaways



**Always connect  
your findings  
back to value  
for the client**



**Write reports  
that work for  
all audiences**



**Lead debriefs  
with confidence  
and empathy**



**Focus on the business  
impact of your findings**



**Build soft skills as  
deliberately as  
technical ones**

# Thank You



**Dumisani Masimini**  
Penetration Tester



## Q&A